

Work/Life Balance Leadership Exercise

With your team, identify and agree upon 3 or more core tenets which could collectively improve work/life balance.



Identify team tenets to promote work/life balance and wellness

- Explain the importance of a positive work/life balance to your team.

Notes on the importance of work/life balance:

ADVANTAGES OF A GOOD WLB

- Increased motivation and productivity at work.
- Greater job satisfaction.
- More time for healthy eating and exercise leading to improved health and well-being.
- More time to spend with family and on hobbies / leisure.
- Reduced stress and burnout.

IMPACT OF A POOR WLB

- Reduced productivity.
- Low morale at work.
- Stress and fatigue.
- Lower relationship satisfaction.
- Sickness and burnout.

- Brainstorm possible team tenets which could promote work/life balance and wellness. Brainstorm for 15 minutes.
- Write the team's proposed tenets on post-it notes or on a virtual whiteboard.
- Once finished, read out each tenet. Ask for a tenet to be explained if required, but don't judge or reject any.
- Sort the tenets into similar groups.
- Give each team member 3 or more votes, depending on how many tenets you wish to be finally selected.
- For each highest voted tenet clarify and document the clear intent behind it.
- Publish the tenets, perhaps on an image of a scroll or tablet of stone for example.



As a leader, think about how you will role model these tenets and behaviours.

Taking Control

There are steps you can take to improve your work/life balance:

Mentalhealth.org.uk & Apollo Technical & Jeff Davison 2018



SELF-MANAGEMENT

Prioritise your health irrespective of how busy you are, take proper breaks at work.



TIME MANAGEMENT

Try to 'work smart, not long', prioritise and set appropriate goals.



MANAGE STRESS

Do a job you are passionate about – you will be more productive and less stressed.



SPEAK UP

Speak up when the expectations and demands of work are too much.



DELEGATE

Delegate tasks at work where possible.



SEPARATE

Separate work and home; keep to a routine at home, have a dedicated workspace and switch off when the working day is over.



MANAGE FREE TIME

Manage leisure time and vary activities to avoid monotony.



SCHEDULE

Schedule quality time for family and friends, consider getting help with chores and childcare to create more spare time.

The Role of Leadership

How leaders can improve work/life balance for employees:



COMMUNICATION

Encourage employees to speak up when under too much pressure and regularly review their workloads.



LEADERSHIP

Lead by example -
Discourage working after prescribed hours.



TRAINING

Train managers to spot stress and poor work-life balance.



FLEXIBILITY

Offer flexible and remote working where possible, for example to support parents and carers.



BREAKS

Instigate policies to ensure adequate breaks are taken, both during the day and by using annual leave.



ACTIVITIES

Encourage stress-relieving activities such as lunchtime exercise, relaxation classes and volunteering.



SUPPORT

Encourage employees to consider what would improve their work-life balance and offer coaching if appropriate.